

# “No compromise on agriculture, US deal is a win-win”

**Piyush Goyal, Union Minister for Commerce and Industry**, on the India-US trade deal, and what the new pacts signal about India

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He is the face of India's trade diplomacy at a time when global commerce is being re-ordered—by geopolitics, supply-chain realignments, and a sharper contest for markets, capital and technology. So, when India moved decisively on two big-ticket trade deals—one with the European Union and another with the United States—it made sense to speak with Piyush Goyal, Union Minister for Commerce and Industry, and one of the key architects of India's external economic strategy.

In a freewheeling conversation, with

**Raj Chengappa, Group Editorial Director, India Today Magazine**, Goyal spoke about what these headline agreements signal for Indian exporters, manufacturers and services companies looking to plug into new growth corridors. He also addressed the core questions businesses are asking—what India is willing to open up, where it will hold the line, and how the government plans to convert diplomatic momentum into tangible gains on the ground for the country.

Goyal argues that the new trade push is not just about deals for the sake of it, but about securing India's interests in a world where trade is increasingly about standards, sustainability norms and strategic alignment. He outlines how India is positioning itself as a reliable partner while protecting sensitive sectors—and why speed, scale and competitiveness will define the next phase of India's growth story. Edited excerpts: